Game: Shadow Watch

Instructor key · Req 5c (view running processes) · 4 minutes in the Defenses block

What it teaches

Every running program is a **process**. Security people check processes to spot malware. The skill: open the process viewer, sort it, and tell normal from suspicious.

Before class

Print the whole packet. Pages 2 and 3 hold the clue cards (read aloud or hold up) and the lodge answer sheets. Test the steps yourself on your own laptop first. On a phone there is no process viewer, so those Wardens pair with a laptop owner.

Run it

Open the viewer: **Windows** press Ctrl + Shift + Esc (Task Manager). **Mac** press Cmd + Space, type Activity Monitor, press Return. Read the clues one at a time. The first lodge to find each answer raises a hand and shows you. After each clue, discuss what is normal. **Points:** +1 for each clue answered first. Never let Wardens end a process they do not understand.

#	Clue	How to find it	Say
1	**Biggest memory** Find the program using the most memory right now.	Windows: Task Manager > Processes > click the **Memory** column header to sort. Mac: Activity Monitor > **Memory** tab > click the **Memory** column.	Usually a web browser or a big app. Ask: is that what you expected?
2	**Your browser** Find the process for your web browser.	Windows: look under Apps for Chrome, Edge or Firefox. Mac: look for Safari or Google Chrome in the list.	Browsers split into many processes, one per tab or helper. That is normal.
3	**A name you do not know** Pick one process you do not recognize and search its name online.	Pick any unfamiliar name. Search for the exact name plus the word process, and read what a trusted site says. Do not open links from ads.	Most unfamiliar names are normal system helpers. Lookup is how security people check, instead of guessing.
4	**How many processes** Find out how many processes are running.	Windows: Task Manager > **Performance** tab > CPU: the Processes number. Mac: Activity Monitor > **CPU** tab: Processes at the bottom.	There are usually hundreds. That is normal. Ask why a computer needs so many.
5	**Safe to close** Find a process you can safely close.	Open a simple app yourself, such as Calculator, then find it in the list. Close it with its own close button, not by ending a system process.	Only close an app you opened yourself with nothing unsaved. End a task only for a frozen app, with a parent or leader.

Normal

Names you can look up, a few big apps using the most memory, hundreds of processes in total, many browser helpers.

Suspicious signs

A random-letter or look-alike name, very high CPU with nothing open, an app you never installed, or a window that appears and asks you to pay or call someone.

Safety: look, but do not close anything you do not understand. Names here are examples of what to discuss, not a list of what is safe.

Clue cards

Read aloud or hold up one at a time

Biggest memory

1

Find the program using the most memory right now.

Your browser

2

Find the process for your web browser.

A name you do not know

3

Pick one process you do not recognize and search its name online.

How many processes

4

Find out how many processes are running.

Safe to close

5

Find a process you can safely close.

Lodge answer sheets

Cut apart · one per lodge

LODGE 1

	Clue	Our answer	Counselor
1	Biggest memory		
2	Your browser		
3	A name you do not know		
4	How many processes		
5	Safe to close		

☐ We did not close anything we did not understand Suspicious sign we could name: _____

LODGE 2

	Clue	Our answer	Counselor
1	Biggest memory		
2	Your browser		
3	A name you do not know		
4	How many processes		
5	Safe to close		

☐ We did not close anything we did not understand Suspicious sign we could name: _____

LODGE 3

	Clue	Our answer	Counselor
1	Biggest memory		
2	Your browser		
3	A name you do not know		
4	How many processes		
5	Safe to close		

☐ We did not close anything we did not understand Suspicious sign we could name: _____

Lodge answer sheets (continued)

Lodges 4-6

LODGE 4

	Clue	Our answer	Counselor
1	Biggest memory		
2	Your browser		
3	A name you do not know		
4	How many processes		
5	Safe to close		

☐ We did not close anything we did not understand Suspicious sign we could name: _____

LODGE 5

	Clue	Our answer	Counselor
1	Biggest memory		
2	Your browser		
3	A name you do not know		
4	How many processes		
5	Safe to close		

☐ We did not close anything we did not understand Suspicious sign we could name: _____

LODGE 6

	Clue	Our answer	Counselor
1	Biggest memory		
2	Your browser		
3	A name you do not know		
4	How many processes		
5	Safe to close		

☐ We did not close anything we did not understand Suspicious sign we could name: _____